

BOARD PROSPECT MATERIALS

Founding Leadership & Governance Brief

Georgia Film Society

A private reference for prospective board leaders and institutional partners.

PURPOSE

Georgia Film Society is being built as a serious cinematic cultural institution for Georgia and the American South: filmmaker-first, story-first, merit-first, and designed with the long view in mind.

This brief exists for the private site and board prospect process. It is not a finished public board roster. It is a concise guide to the organization's founding leadership posture, governance foundation, board-development priorities, and stewardship standards.

The intent is simple: help prospective board leaders understand that GFS is not merely launching events. It is assembling the governance, relationships, and cultural credibility required to build an enduring institution.

AT A GLANCE

Document Type

Private board prospect support brief

Institution

Georgia Film Society, Inc.

Current Phase

Institutional positioning and relationship cultivation

Leadership Posture

Founder-led, governance-aware, board in development

Strategic Aim

Build long-term cultural legitimacy before public scale

The opportunity is not simply to join a board. It is to help shape the founding stewardship of a cinematic cultural institution for Georgia and the South.

- Georgia Film Society

FOUNDING LEADERSHIP

Founder-led, institution-first, board-aware.

At this stage, the strongest leadership presentation is honest: GFS is founder-led while its board and advisory ecosystem are being cultivated intentionally.

CURRENT PUBLIC-FACING LEADERSHIP

Kris Shuman

FOUNDER & PRESIDENT

Kris Shuman is the founder and president of Georgia Film Society. He leads the institution's founding vision, cultural positioning, strategic development, and board-prospect cultivation around the belief that Georgia's production strength should be matched by serious cinematic institutions. His work is focused on storytelling, filmmaker support, membership, patronage, partnerships, student access, year-round programming, and the long-term cultural life of cinema in Georgia and the South.

Timea Shuman

SECRETARY

Supports governance continuity, records, official documentation, and the formation-stage responsibilities connected to the organization's leadership structure.

Board & Officer Development

IN PROGRESS

Additional board and officer appointments should be finalized deliberately, with public-facing roles announced only when aligned people are confirmed and ready.

HOW THIS SHOULD READ TO A PROSPECT

GFS is presenting a serious founding-stage institution with governance structure in place and an aligned board search underway.

GOVERNANCE FOUNDATION

Structure before spectacle.

The purpose of this page is to show that GFS is being developed with real nonprofit governance infrastructure, not just branding, events, or ambition.

Board of Directors

GOVERNANCE OVERSIGHT

The affairs of Georgia Film Society are managed under the direction of the Board of Directors. Board service supports mission integrity, public trust, and strategic accountability.

President

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP

Provides executive leadership, executes Board-approved strategy, supervises organizational activity, and represents the institution publicly.

Secretary

RECORDS & CONTINUITY

Maintains corporate records, meeting minutes, official documentation, and governance continuity as the organization develops.

Treasurer

FINANCIAL OVERSIGHT

Oversees financial records and reporting. This role should be filled carefully by an aligned, trusted person with appropriate financial or governance strength.

ADVISORY LEADERSHIP

The Board or President may establish advisory boards, councils, or advisory committees. These bodies are advisory unless governing authority is expressly delegated.

MEMBERSHIP CLARIFICATION

Supporters, members, patrons, and donors can participate in the institution without receiving voting or governance rights unless separately authorized by the Board.

Governance is the framework that protects the mission, the relationships, and the long-term credibility of the institution.

BOARD DEVELOPMENT

The founding board should be built with restraint.

GFS should seek leaders who strengthen credibility, public trust, relationships, institutional care, and long-term cultural seriousness - not people who simply fill seats.

IDEAL FOUNDING BOARD PROFILES

- Civic or regional leaders with Georgia credibility.
- Entertainment, media, arts, or cultural leaders with taste and seriousness.
- Donor-connected patrons or builders who understand relationship-based support.
- Hospitality, luxury, tourism, or business leaders aligned with elevated cultural experience.
- Legal, accounting, finance, or nonprofit governance professionals.
- Education, student-access, workforce, or community leaders.
- Technology and future-of-storytelling voices who respect artistic integrity.

STEWARDSHIP EXPECTATIONS**Mission Alignment**

protect the story-first, filmmaker-first purpose

Public Trust

act with transparency, care, and ethical judgment

Relationship Cultivation

open doors before asking for support

Institutional Restraint

prioritize quality, patience, and cultural legitimacy

Practical Support

help with board development, sponsorship readiness, donor confidence, and civic credibility

THE INVITATION

Georgia Film Society is seeking founding board leaders who understand that stewardship is not symbolic. It is the work of helping build something durable, credible, and culturally meaningful.

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